

**POLARIS SDVOSB GWAC
QUESTION AND RESPONSE DOCUMENT #1**

Thank you for your interest in the Polaris SDVOSB GWAC.

Legacy questions and responses (Q&R) from the Polaris SB and Polaris WOSB Request for Proposal (RFP) are provided. These Q&Rs are applicable to the Polaris SDVOSB RFP.

In addressing questions, it is the Government's position that if the solicitation's position is self-evident, the response to a question may simply be that the solicitation already addresses the matter in the manner the Government intended for it to be addressed.

While the Government may include one or more specific solicitation passages in a response to a question, interested parties are reminded that section L.3 of the solicitation states, "Offerors are instructed to read the entire solicitation document, including all attachments in Section J, prior to submitting questions and/or preparing a proposal. Omission of any information from the proposal submission requirements may result in rejection of the offer."

Questions were not extensively edited for grammar, punctuation or spelling. Not every question is shown. Only those questions, or portions of questions, that were deemed frequently asked and/or those that were deemed to benefit the procurement process are shown.

Questions and responses are organized into topic areas shown below. Interested parties stand to benefit from reviewing all statements, questions, and responses.

- General
- Relevant Experience
- Past Performance
- Systems, Certifications and Clearances
- Organizational Risk Assessment
- Teaming
- Representations and Certifications
- Responsibility
- Polaris Submission Portal (PSP)

This is the first Q&R document. Additional Q&R documents will be posted to SAM.gov as appropriate. It is the responsibility of the Offerors to periodically check the solicitation on SAM.gov for more information.

General		
Q&R #	Question	Response
1	Where can the title page markings for restriction on disclosure and use of data be included?	Concerning the markings identified in FAR 52.215-1, an optional cover page may be attached within the PSP document submission.
2	Will the Government be providing a SCRM Plan template?	As noted in G.17.1, GSA will provide a C-SCRM Plan template to contractors post-award, prior to the submission dates indicated in Section F.6, Deliverables.
3	Can the Contractor Program Manager and the Contractor Contract Manager described in G.5.1 and G.5.2, respectively, be the same person?	There is no restriction on the same individual fulfilling both roles.
4	Can the Government please clarify the distinction between deliverables 11 and 13? The table implies that the deliverable is identical for these two items. Thus it is unclear for specifically which deliverable # will the contractor's performance be assessed.	Deliverable 13 refers to the remittance of CAF while Deliverable 11 is the reporting of this remittance.
5	How should Offerors acknowledge amendments?	Reference L.5.1.1, the Offeror must acknowledge each amendment number and date in Block 14 of the SF33 or complete Blocks 8 and 15 of the SF30 for each amendment.
6	F.2, Master Contract Ordering Period, states ordering period of this contract to be from (To Be Determined) through (To Be Determined). Is there any additional information available on these dates?	The contract ordering period for the Master Contract is from the date of the Notice-To-Proceed through five years thereafter, with one, five-year option that may extend the cumulative term of the contract to 10 years.
7	Does the Government intend to award to companies based on their initial submission, or does the Government plan to have a second proposal phase?	Per section M.2, Basis for Awards, the Government intends to award contracts without discussions. Proposals must contain the best offer.
8	Is vessel or aircraft insurance required?	See G.9 (d) and (e), the applicable insurance is required when task order performance involves the use of aircraft or vessels.
9	Will digital signatures be accepted on the J.P-2, J.P-4, and J.P-6?	Yes, digital signatures may be utilized.

10	Would the Government clarify that the Contractor Program Manager identified in Section G. 5.1 is not expected to serve at the Task Order level and that a separate Program Manager may be proposed for Task Order support?	In accordance with G.5.1, the Contractor Program Manager is not required to serve at the task order level. A separate Program Manager may be proposed when necessary for a given task order.
11	May offerors use the same form on all proposal submissions for all pools to alleviate having to reach out to customers multiple times for the same input?	Yes, the same supporting documentation (J.P-4, J.P-6, etc.) may be submitted for proposals for all Pools.
12	Does GSA have a prescribed naming convention for the documents that will be uploaded to the PSP?	No prescribed naming conventions or volume structure is required. Documents will be associated with the claimed elements within the PSP.
13	Will GSA provide detailed formatting guidelines (e.g., page limit, font style and size)? Please confirm if there is no specific formatting requirement.	The RFP sets no specific formatting requirements regarding font, size, headers, footers or page limits.
14	Is a PDF file acceptable for any supporting documentation required for scored evaluation, including attachments to the RFP originally in Microsoft Word format?	All files submitted must be in PDF format. This includes RFP attachments that were originally in Microsoft Word format.
15	Please confirm if the Offerors need to fill out a scoresheet with our own listing of scoring points as in the M.6 Polaris Scoring Table, or is that calculated by GSA.	The Offeror's claimed score will be calculated within the PSP based on scoring elements claimed.
16	Does the Government intend to provide a self-scoring matrix for Offerors to calculate and submit their self-scores as part of the proposal submission? If not, where are Offerors expected to identify their total self-score?	The claimed score is calculated and visible within the PSP during proposal preparation and submission.
17	Do we need to submit resumes for Key Personnel?	The RFP identifies no key personnel or resume requirements.
18	May the GSA Form 527 and other forms be password protected?	See L.4. Proposal submissions must not be locked, encrypted, or otherwise contain barriers to opening.
19	Will the government advise the minimum number of total points required for Offerors to qualify for an award for each Pool?	The RFP does not establish a minimum score for an award. Reference M.2, Basis of Award.

20		Are small businesses permitted to participate in multiple teams as subcontractors?	Yes, as noted within L.3, Proposal Submission Instructions, "A small business concern may participate under multiple proposals (e.g., Offeror, proposed subcontractor, joint venture member), however, per L.5.2, Relevant Experience, no project, to include Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, may be used in more than one proposal under this Solicitation."
21		Is a small business that submits a prime contractor proposal allowed to join another's team as a subcontractor?	Yes, as noted within L.3, Proposal Submission Instructions, "An Offeror (as identified in Block 15A of the SF33) may only submit a single proposal for this Pool. ... A small business concern may participate under multiple proposals (e.g., Offeror, proposed subcontractor, joint venture member), however, per L.5.2, Relevant Experience, no project, to include Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, may be used in more than one proposal under this Solicitation."
22		Can an SB Offeror submit a proposal as a prime Offeror in the SB pool and submit a 2nd proposal as a member of a JV in the same Pool?	Yes, as noted within L.3, Proposal Submission Instructions, "An Offeror (as identified in Block 15A of the SF33) may only submit a single proposal for this Pool. ... A small business concern may participate under multiple proposals (e.g., Offeror, proposed subcontractor, joint venture member), however, per L.5.2, Relevant Experience, no project, to include Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, may be used in more than one proposal under this Solicitation."
23		In submitting verification documents for projects, may support documents include redactions?	Redactions within verification documents are acceptable; however, the unredacted information must provide sufficient information to validate the claim.

24		In the situation where the CO's signature is unattainable (due to the fact the CO has retired or left the Agency), what should be noted for their direct telephone number and email address?	The Contracting Officer's previous telephone number and email address should be included on the form. In accordance with Section L. 5.2.2.1.1(2)(b), Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Federal Government Contracts), if the cognizant Contracting Officer's signature is unattainable, the Government will accept the signature of the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) or other Government Employee with cognizance over the submitted Project. The Project Verification Form must include both cognizant CO's and verifying government employee's direct telephone numbers and email addresses.
25		Please confirm that Offerors are not required to submit any pricing or rate information with their proposal.	Confirmed. In accordance with 41 U.S.C. 3306(c) and associated GSA Class Deviation CD-2020-14, cost and pricing information will not be considered at the Master Contract level.
26		Can project values be rounded up in order to get the commensurate number of points?	No, specific project values should be entered. Values should not be rounded.
27		Is a link to subcontractors webpage from primes Polaris page allowed?	Per G.7, the subcontractor information may reside on the prime contractor's Polaris webpage.
28		If a vendor is SDVOSB, are they able to submit a proposal for the SB Pool and the SDVOSB pool? Or can you only submit one proposal as prime across all pools?	An offeror may propose to each pool for which it is eligible. An Offeror is limited to one (1) contract per pool.
29		Where is the scorecard?	Please refer to M.6, Polaris Scoring Table.
30		Can you please help me find the J-2 attachment and the other Master Contract Document attachments?	Attachments J-1 through J-4 are provided within the RFP file after Section M.
31		L.5.1.3.2 What is the file naming convention for each "Subcontractor Letter of Commitment"?	No prescribed naming conventions or volume structure is required. Documents will be associated with the claimed elements within the PSP.

32		Can the Contractor add Labor Categories at the ID/IQ level at the time of submission of this proposal response?	No, additional labor categories may not be added at this time. Reference B.7 for information on utilizing additional labor categories when necessary to provide an IT services-based solution for a specific task order.
33		G.5.1 and G.5.2 indicate that the Contractor Program Manager and Contractor Contract Manager must be a "direct employee of the company." Can these personnel be employees of a parent company?	Yes, the Contractor Program Manager and Contractor Contract Manager can be from the parent company of the contractor.
34		On the SF33, does the Government still wish for Offerors to update Block 13 or add a discount for CALENDAR DAYS (%)?	No entry is required in Block 13. Offerors may offer prompt payment discount terms; however, it will have no bearing on the award decision as cost and pricing information are not being considered at the master contract level
35		Where in block 15A of the SF33 should the UEI be included?	Per L.5.1.1, the Offeror must include their UEI (SAM) within Block 15A on the SF33. The UEI can be included in the same text field as the offeror's address.
36		Our address recently changed but this is not yet reflected in our SAM account as it is pending validation. Can we submit supporting documents to explain the difference in the address on our SF33 compared to SAM?	Yes. If the address in SAM differs from the address included on the SF33, attach a cover letter indicating the reason for this discrepancy. No additional documents are necessary to demonstrate the current address beyond the cover letter.
Relevant Experience			
Q&R #		Question	Response
37		May multiple NAICS be claimed from a single project?	Section L.5.2.2(a). Only one NAICS may be claimed for a project.
38		Can Offerors receive points for cost-reimbursement projects even if there is only one cost reimbursable CLIN?	Yes, L.5.2.2.4, the Offeror will receive additional points if the Projects (either the contract or a specific CLIN) are United States Federal Government Cost-Reimbursement, specifically any of the cost-reimbursement contract types specified under FAR Subpart 16.3, Cost-Reimbursement Contracts.

39		Can the Government confirm that the Emerging Technology projects do not need to be from the 3 – 5 Relevant Experience projects submitted for L.5.2 (Paragraph a.)?	Confirmed. Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects may be distinct from Primary Relevant Experience Projects. However, as noted within L.5.2.3, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, it is acceptable for the same Project to be submitted for both Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience.
40		The RFP states: "It is acceptable for the same Project to be submitted for both Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience." Please confirm that it is not required for the Emerging Technology Relevant Experience to have been submitted as primary Relevant Experience.	Confirmed. There's no requirement for an Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project to be submitted as a Primary Relevant Experience Project.
41		What is the minimum number of required relevant experience projects for Emerging Technology?	Submission of Emerging Technology Relevant Experience is not mandatory; however, Offerors who demonstrate Emerging Technology Relevant Experience within their proposal will receive additional points per scoring table, Section M.6.
42		It is our understanding that the emerging technology references do not need to be included in the NAICS listing provided in L. 5.2.2.1. Will the government please confirm this is correct?	Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects submitted for Section L.5.2.3 are not required to map to the Primary Relevant Experience NAICS Areas identified at Section L.5.2.2.1.
43		Given that it is an evaluation requirement, and a source of points on the scorecard, may GSA clarify if emerging technologies that are not listed within the RFP are acceptable to submit, and will count towards the scorecard total?	Per section L.5.2.3, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, each Project must have included the performance of one of the Emerging Technologies listed in L. 5.2.3.1, Emerging Technology Listing, to be eligible for scoring.
44		In the Emerging Technology block on form J.P-6, does the Government want Offerors to provide a narrative of the emerging technology claimed, or only provide the emerging technology category from RFP L. 5.2.3.1?	The Offeror should identify the claimed emerging technology from L.5.2.3.1, Emerging Technology Listing. No narrative is requested.

45	We currently hold a Federal Prime contract with an Intelligence Community customer for which we have our unclassified contract and statement of work. However, given the IC policy to not include their contracts in the publicly available FPDS we are not able to submit reports from FPDS as evidence of our contract. Please confirm the Government will accept the official contract documents to validate the required scoring elements.	Reference L.5.2.2.1.1 (2), Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Federal Government Contracts), which identifies the documents required for verification when an FPDS-NG Report is not available.
46	Is the Offeror required to meet all the services under a specific Innovative Solutions and/or Performance Area section to meet the requirements of the RFP? For example, under IT Operation and Management, we do not have helpdesk experience however, we possess system administration experience.	Reference Section M.2, Basis for Awards. The solicitation includes no requirement for the Offeror to demonstrate all the services under a specific innovative solutions and/or performance area. The Government will evaluate proposals in accordance with the instructions and evaluation criteria set forth in Sections L and M of the solicitation.
47	Section L.3.2, Mergers, Acquisitions, and Novations, as Applicable states, "By the closing date of this solicitation, if a company has acquired part or all of another company, the transferee company (the company acquiring the other company) may claim credit for the additional points for Relevant Experience Projects and the Past Performance Projects so long as a Government approved novation of a U.S. Federal contract from one contractor to another has been made." Does this apply to Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects as well?	This reference to "Relevant Experience Projects" encompasses all relevant experience projects within L.5.2, both Primary Relevant Experience Projects and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects.
48	Can the same relevant experience projects be used in multiple-pools?	There is no restriction on utilizing the same Relevant Experience Projects and Past Performance in proposals for separate Polaris pools. However, as noted within Section L.5.2.1, projects submitted as Primary Relevant Experience Projects or Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects may not be used in more than one proposal for a Pool.

49		Is the J.P-2 for Offerors proposing as a joint venture?	The J.P-2 is specific to experience performed as a member of a joint venture being claimed in accordance with L.5.1.3.3.
50		If a NAICS code being claimed is different than the primary NAICS code specified on the FPDS-NG report, how should this be specified on the Project Verification form?	The claimed NAICS should be identified on the project verification form.
51		Instructions require Offerors to submit a copy of the Contract SOW/PWS when FPDS does not verify the NAICS claimed, to demonstrate claims for emerging technology, and to substantiate relevant experience for cybersecurity scoring elements. Are Offerors to provide the entire Contract SOW/PWS or would the Government prefer to only receive excerpts that demonstrate the claimed NAICSs be provided to support ease in the Government's evaluation?	Offerors are to submit a copy of the SOW/PWS in its entirety.
52		Can multiple NAICS be claimed for a single project?	See Section L.5.2.2, only one NAICS may be claimed for a project.
53		Can a PSC be used for verification of Primary Relevant Experience instead of NAICS?	The RFP does not provide for verification based on PSC.
54		Can federal contracts with non-federal governments be counted for scoring in L.5.2.2.3?	As stated in L.5.2.2.3, These points are only available for Relevant Experience Projects performed as a prime contractor to the Federal Government. Task orders with a state or local government are not eligible for this additional scoring.
55		Can Cybersecurity experience for L.5.2.2.7 be from outside the federal government?	Section L.5.2.2.7 includes no requirement for the experience to be with the Federal Government.
56		Please confirm that Prime Offerors are permitted to submit past performance references from Sub-contractors in Teaming Agreement.	● L.5.2 Relevant Experience - Relevant Experience Projects may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor. ● L.5.3 Past Performance - Past performance examples may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor.

57	With respect to performance, each Primary Relevant Experience Project must be complete or have at least one year of performance. Can the government please verify this is one year from proposal due date, similar to the requirements for project to be completed within five years of when proposals are due?	Per L.5.2.2 and L.5.2.3, Projects must have at least six (6) months of performance by the date proposals are due.
58	Can a Project submitted as an Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project in one proposal for this pool be used as a Primary Relevant Experience Project in a different proposal for this pool, and vice versa?	No, reference L.5.2.1, "Projects submitted as Primary Relevant Experience Projects or Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects may not be used in more than one proposal for this Pool. Projects used in more than one proposal for this Pool will be removed from all proposals and will not be evaluated as part of any Offeror's proposal. It is the Offeror's sole responsibility to ensure that the Projects submitted as part of its proposal are not submitted in any other proposals for this pool."
59	Per L.5.2.1 not allowing the same relevant experience to be used in more than one proposal in the same pool, is a vendor allowed to use the same relevant experience in multiple/different pools? For example, use one in the HUBzone and use the same project in the SDVOSB Pool?	There is no restriction on using the same project across multiple pools.
60	If the Offeror holds a task order with contract renewals/continuation of services (with exactly the same scope) awarded under different contract numbers, can the Offeror consider this a single project for scoring purposes?	No, for the purposes of evaluation, separate contract awards cannot be aggregated into a single Relevant Experience Project.
61	Does the government have a means to receive a classified Statement of Work to submit an experience that is for classified work?	No. Classified information must not be submitted through the PSP or through any other means in response to the Polaris RFP.
62	For the relevant experience verification, can rate information be redacted as long as total project value is revealed?	Yes, rate information can be redacted as long as the total project value can be validated.

63		Can ALL the submitted projects be non-federal? or is there a minimum of federal experience needed?	L.5.2.1 states, any combination of federal government and non-federal Projects can be submitted. There is no requirement for exclusive Federal Government experience only.
64		Please confirm whether a single contract that is used for L.5.2.2 Relevant Experience AND for L. 5.2.3 Emerging Technology may use a single J.P-6 Project Verification Form for documenting scoring elements, or whether these need to be provided as two separate artifacts, one for the project under L.5.2.2 Relevant Experience scoring and one for the project under L.5.2.3 Emerging Technology scoring.	A single Project Verification Form may be used when a Project is being submitted for both L.5.2.2 and L.5.2.3.
65		Will the Government confirm that an Offeror is permitted to use a proposed Subcontractor's relevant experience project as one of its (5) five primary relevant experience projects even if the Subcontractor was not the prime on the contract?	Yes, an Offeror can use its subcontractor's experience as one of the 5 Relevant Experience Projects. The requirements of L. 5.1.3.2 must be met. Additionally, if the project was performed as a subcontractor, the verification method at L.5.2.2.1.2 Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Non-Federal Contracts and Federal Government Subcontracts) must be utilized.
66		Does the Offeror need to submit anything else besides the FPDS-NG to receive point credit for NAICS Code, Cost Reimbursement, Dollar Size, Multi-Govt Customers (Funding Code), Multi-Award, & OCONUS?	Per L.5.2.2.1.1(1) Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Federal Government Contracts), Offerors should submit a FPDS-NG Report(s) that provides verification of all claimed scoring elements. If the FPDS is not available, or does not substantiate ALL scored elements, the verification process at L.5.2.2.1.1(2) should be used. No additional documentation is required if a FPDS-NG Report provides verification of all claimed scoring elements.

67		To confirm, if an Offeror submits an FPDS-NG Report that provides verification of all claimed scoring elements, then the Offeror is NOT required to submit additional verification documents such as a signed copy of original contract award document, copy of contract statement of work, etc., correct?	Correct. See L.5.2.2.1.1. When a FPDS-NG Report provides verification of all claimed scoring elements, no additional documentation is required for verification. Note - FPDS cannot provide verification of L.5.2.2.7, Relevant Experience Project Providing Cybersecurity Services, or L.5.2.3, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience.
68		Could you reconfirm that if FPDS-NG Report provides verification of all claimed scoring elements, then the Offeror need not submit the contract award form or SOW?	Per L.5.2.2.1.1, no additional documents must be submitted when the FPDS-NG Report that provides verification of all claimed scoring elements. Note - FPDS cannot provide verification of L.5.2.2.7, Relevant Experience Project Providing Cybersecurity Services, or L.5.2.3, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience.
69		Can we provide a narrative to support the additional SOW verification?	A narrative detailing the work performed is not requested or required; however, note Section L.3 - While some sub-sections of Section L may indicate an Offeror must provide a particular form of documentation for validation purposes, Offerors may provide additional verifiable documentation to validate any claimed scoring elements.
70		Per section L.5.2.2.1.2, if claiming experience as a subcontractor to a prime on a federal contract, does the experience count towards federal contracts experience?	Per L.5.2.2.1.2, Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Non-Federal Contracts and Federal Government Subcontracts), This verification method should be used when relevant experience was performed as a subcontractor, EVEN if the subcontract was to a Prime Contractor performing a federal government contract. NOTE: Non-federal Contracts are not eligible to receive points for elements L. 5.2.2.3, L.5.2.2.4, L.5.2.2.5, or L. 5.2.2.6.

71		Can projects be reused in different pools of Polaris?	Relevant Experience Projects may be claimed in offers for multiple Polaris pools. As noted within L. 5.2.1, Projects submitted as Primary Relevant Experience Projects or Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects may not be used in more than one proposal for a specific Pool.
72		Could an entire Blanket Purchase Agreement be used as a "Project"?	An entire BPA may not be utilized as a project per L.5.2.1. A Relevant Experience Project (also referred to as a "Project") is defined as (1) a single contract or subcontract; (2) a single task order awarded under a Multiple Award contract (as defined below); (3) a single task order awarded under a master Single-Award Indefinite Delivery task order contract (Definite Quantity, Requirements, or Indefinite Quantity) (FAR 16.5); (4) a single task order placed under a Federal Supply Schedule contract (FAR 8.405-2); (5) a single task order placed under a Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) (FAR 8.405-3 or FAR 13.303); (6) a single task order placed under a Basic Ordering Agreement (BOA) (FAR 16.703); (7) a single Other Transaction Authority (OTA) award issued under 10 U.S. C. 4021 or other applicable authority; or (8) a single grant.
73		Will GSA allow multiple task order awards under a single award BPA or IDIQ count toward relevant size?	No, separate contract awards or task orders cannot be aggregated into a single Relevant Experience Project.

74		The RFP states "The Offeror must submit a MINIMUM OF THREE (3) and may submit a MAXIMUM OF FIVE (5) distinct Primary Relevant Experience Projects" under Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects. Please confirm the total maximum number of projects we can submit. Are we to submit a minimum of 6 with a max of 10?	L.5.2.2, Primary Relevant Experience Submission states, "The Offeror must submit a MINIMUM OF THREE (3) and may submit a MAXIMUM OF FIVE (5) distinct Primary Relevant Experience Projects." and L.5.2.3, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience states, "the Offeror may submit a MAXIMUM of three (3) Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Projects." Offerors must submit a minimum of three Primary Relevant Experience projects) and may submit up to eight total relevant experience projects (up to five Primary Relevant Experience projects and up to three Emerging Technology Relevant Experience projects).
75		Will the Government please confirm that offerors may submit more detailed Contract Deliverables (e.g., Monthly Status Reports) as acceptable documentation aligning to Primary Relevant Experience Performance Areas and to Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Areas?	Yes, note Section L.3 - While some sub-sections of Section L may indicate an Offeror must provide a particular form of documentation for validation purposes, Offerors may provide additional verifiable documentation to validate any claimed scoring elements.
76		Section L.5.2.1 Relevant Experience Projects (Definitions) lists several standard forms and documents that are used as award documents. Will the Government also accept the most recently signed SF 30 modifying an award as an award document?	A signed SF30 may be provided in addition to the required contract award form. Reference Section L.3 - While some sub-sections of Section L may indicate an Offeror must provide a particular form of documentation for validation purposes, Offerors may provide additional verifiable documentation to validate any claimed scoring elements.
77		Will you consider contracts with the Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority (WMATA) in lieu of Federal experience to allow for points under section L. 5.2.2.3, L.5.2.2.4, L.5.2.2.5 and L.5.2.2.6?	No, WMATA is not a federal agency. Contracts with WMATA will be considered as non-federal.

78	Do each of the five maximum projects allowed for scoring under a Task Order against a Federal Multiple-Award IDIQ Contract have to be against a unique Multiple-Award IDIQ Contract, or can more than one project still qualify for additional scoring if it is under the same Multiple-Award IDIQ contract as another project?	Relevant Experience Projects do not need to be under different Multiple Award IDIQs in order to receive points for L.5.2.2.
79	Can the Government confirm that these requirements in L.5.1.3.3 only apply to joint venture offerors who plan to submit relevant experience examples performed by the joint venture as the prime contractor, and not joint venture offerors who plan to submit relevant experience examples performed by either the mentor or the protege as the prime contractor?	L.5.1.3.3 is specific to the use of experience performed as a member of a joint venture.
80	When proposing in multiple pools, are offerors allowed to use the same signed J.P-2 Joint Venture Experience Template (or J.P-6 Project Verification Form) across multiple submissions?	The same verification documents may be utilized for the SB, WOSB, HUBZone and SDVOSB solicitations.
81	Is there any exception to the requirements of L.5.2.2.1.1(2), L. 5.2.2.1.2 and L.5.2.3.1.1 for award documents and statements of work that we are not authorized to release?	No. To receive claimed scoring, the applicable verification documents must be submitted.
82	In a situation where a series of task orders are issued against a Single-Award IDIQ contract; can the offeror claim the total project size based on the IDIQ?	See L.5.2.1, An indefinite delivery, indefinite quantity contract may not be claimed as a project unless performance is evident through funding at the contract level. Typically, performance on an indefinite delivery, indefinite quantity contract is through one or more task orders. As noted in the L.5.2.1, a task order may be submitted as a project. Additionally, task orders may not be aggregated for project value.

83		Can the Government please clarify the difference between the Project Verification Form from the PSP and the J.P-6 Attachment provided by the Government?	The Project Verification Form from either the PSP or Attachment J.P-6, Project Verification Form, may be utilized when required by L. 5.2.2.1.1, L.5.2.2.1.2, or L.5.2.3.1.1. The Project Verification Form from the PSP is prepopulated with the information input into the PSP. The Attachment J.P-6, Project Verification Form, is an alternative that must be manually completed when utilized.
84		Would the Government please provide examples of acceptable documentation to demonstrate breadth of relevant experience?	As noted within L.5.2.2.8, Scoring for this element is only available through the Projects submitted under L.5.2.2. Please refer to L. 5.2.2.1.1 Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Federal Government Contracts) and L.5.2.2.1.2 Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Non-Federal Contracts and Federal Government Subcontracts) for verification requirements.
85		Can Offerors utilize experience from a project that is coded as NAICS 541330 but was for the performance of IT services?	As NAICS 541330 is not one of the NAICS included in L.5.2.2.1, Primary Relevant Experience NAICS Areas, it may not be utilized for relevant experience. However, if the project includes performance in one of the NAICS listed in L.5.2.2.1, that experience may be claimed utilizing the verification process of L. 5.2.2.1.1(2).
86		Section L.5.2.2.1.1 requires "original contract award document" (for Federal Government Contracts) and Section L.5.2.2.1.2(2) (Non-Federal Contracts and Federal Government Subcontracts) requires "Award Form." May Modifications be used as a means of verification?	The contract award form must be provided when required by L. 5.2.2.1.1 or L.5.2.2.1.2; however, as noted in Section L.3, while some sub-sections of Section L may indicate an Offeror must provide a particular form of documentation for validation purposes, Offerors may provide additional verifiable documentation to validate any claimed scoring elements. Contract modifications would be additional verifiable documentation that may be submitted in addition to the required documentation.
87		Can two contracts for a single program be submitted as a project?	No, two contracts may not be submitted as a single Relevant Experience Project. Refer to the definition of a Relevant Experience Project within L.5.2.1.

88		When we started performance on a contract there was just OCONUS travel. During the course of the contract, the Government decided to station some personnel directly in OCONUS locations. A subsequent contract mod has been issued for the same. However FPDS still shows the primary place of performance as DC. Will the contract modification and a signed J.P-6 suffice to claim the OCONUS points?	As noted in L.5.2.2.6, if the FPDS-NG report indicates that the principal place of performance was a CONUS location, then the Offeror must provide a copy of the contract SOW or documents from the contract that detail the OCONUS location(s) at which work was performed, contract award form and an authorized signature as described in L.5.2.2.1.1(2). For the described situation, in addition to the J.P-6 and contract modification, Offeror must also submit the contract award form and SOW. See L.5.2.2.1.1(2).
89		What is the "Non-Government Award Form"?	A contract or award document from other than a federal government entity. Must explicitly identify the Contractor, Non-Government Customer, Contract Value, and the date the customer awarded/signed.
90		Can a contract be split into multiple projects based on CLIN?	No, CLINs within a single contract may not be split into multiple Relevant Experience Projects. Refer to the definition of a Relevant Experience Project within L.5.2.1.
91		L.5.2.2.1.1 Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission – related to the documents, if you use item 2, a-e. Are you only required to send one of the documents listed in item 2 or all the documents?	When providing verification in accordance with L.5.2.2.1.1(2), item (a) must be provided when available if it provides verification of any claimed scoring elements. Items (b), (c), and (d) must all be provided. Item (e) is optional and may be included if experience matching the claimed NAICS is specifically and clearly called out in a single or in multiple CLINs.
92		Related to Section L.5.1.3.3 and J.P-2, can the government clarify whether experience claimed from a Joint venture will be considered a Federal Government Contract for additional scoring?	If the work was awarded to the Joint Venture as a prime contractor to the Federal Government, the Offeror would be eligible for the additional points under Sections L.5.2.2.3, L.5.2.2.4, L.5.2.2.5 and L.5.2.2.6. As noted in L.5.1.3.3(1)(d), any relevant experience elements claimed must be validated for both the Joint Venture contract/order and the Offeror's project. Only the portion of work performed by the Offeror will be considered for the project meeting the requirements or scoring elements of L.5.2.

93		Our contract is federal but the end customer is a state and local government. Please advise if we will get points for either L.5.2.2.3 or L.5.2.2.5 or for both?	As stated in L.5.2.2.3, these points are only available for Relevant Experience Projects performed as a prime contractor to the Federal Government. Task orders with a state or local government are not eligible for this additional scoring.
94		Regarding L.5.2.2.3 Demonstrating Experience with Multiple Federal Government Customers (Federal Government Contracts Only), can GSA confirm the point value for demonstrating experience with two or more federal government customers?	Scoring available for L.5.2.2.3 is as follows: •Two Funding IDs will receive 500 points •Three Funding IDs will receive 1,000 pts •Four Funding IDs will receive 1,500 pts •Five Funding IDs will receive 2,000 pts Offerors providing one Funding ID would not meet the requirements for additional points
95		Can the government please clarify if industry should upload the provided J.P-6 word attachment into the Symphony portal, or should industry use the "generate as PDF" button to generate a new J.P.6 for the government to sign?	Either is acceptable for the Project Verification Form.
96		Given that a project's SOW/PWS are not always fully inclusive of all work being performed on a contract or task order, will the Government allow for further verification of Emerging Technology via other verifiable contractual government documents?	Yes, note Section L.3, while some sub- sections of Section L may indicate an Offeror must provide a particular form of documentation for validation purposes, Offerors may provide additional verifiable documentation to validate any claimed scoring elements.
97		If two separate offerors are subcontractors to the same prime contractor under the same prime contract #, and both wish to use their subcontract as a primary relevant experience or emerging technology qual, please confirm the restriction on using a project once in a pool does not apply to this condition?	In this situation, each subcontractor would be able to submit its subcontract as its own Relevant Experience Project. Each subcontract would be considered a separate and unique project.

98	Referencing L.5.2.2.1 Primary Relevant Experience NAICS Areas: Our project has an erroneous NAICS Code listed in FPDS, and the correct NAICS Code listed on the contract award form. Will the government accept just the signed contract award form with the correct NAICS Code instead of all document requirements listed in L.5.2.2.1.1(2)?	The government will not accept just the signed contract award form for verification. If the FPDS-NG Report does not substantiate all claimed scoring elements, all documents required by L.5.2.2.1.1(2) must be submitted for verification.
99	When submitting the Primary relevant project artifacts for each project, does the government want the offeror to submit a copy of FPDS-NG, Project Verification form or J.P-6 form, Contract Award, and SOW/PWS in one file or a separate file for each artifact?	Either approach is acceptable.
100	Will the Government allow the most recent FPDS-NG report to be from the time of the RFP release and any other reports afterwards not required?	As noted in L.5.2.2.1.1, when multiple FPDS-NG Reports are available, the most recent report must be submitted as well as any previous reports necessary for verification of claimed scoring elements. The most recent report available at time of submission should be included within the proposal.
101	How should offerors handle documentation with multiple components? For example, if multiple FPDS-NG records are required for substantiation, should each record be submitted as a separate file, or can they be combined?	Either method is acceptable. Documents may be combined or submitted as separate files.
102	Referencing L.5.2.2.1.1(2)(d) Relevant Experience Statement of Work requirements: If an amended SOW/PWS/SOO has been issued under the contract, please confirm only the most recent version should be provided?	Confirmed. If a SOW has been amended/modified, only the current (most recent) version should be submitted.

103	Section L.5.2.2.1.2 - Would a fully executed subcontract that includes all required information serve as an acceptable Award Form?	A fully executed subcontract would meet the requirements for the award form if it explicitly identifies the Contractor, Non-Government Customer, Contract Value, and the date the customer awarded/signed; so long as all other documentation submission requirements of L. 5.2.2.1.2 and the RFP are met.
104	When the FPDS does not indicate cost reimbursement, does the offeror need to only submit the contract award documentation indicating cost reimbursement to receive the 3,000 points? Is there other documentation required?	Offeror must provide verification in accordance with L.5.2.2.1.1(2) which includes the Project Verification Form, Contract Award Form, and Statement of Work. This must include contract award documentation that indicates a cost-reimbursement contract type (for the contract or a specific CLIN).
105	Project with Cost Reimbursement. Can a project used be a subcontract for work under a prime Federal government cost reimbursable contract where the offeror serving as a subcontractor has cost reimbursable CLINs flowed down in the subcontract?	No. As noted in L.5.2.2.4, these points are only available for Relevant Experience Projects performed as a prime contractor to the Federal Government.
106	For L.5.2.2.5, please confirm that points for this scoring element are available to an Offeror for prime task order awards performed by its proposed subcontractors against their Multiple award contract.	In this scenario, if the relevant experience project submitted is from a proposed subcontractor, and it meets the criteria of L.2.2.5, then it would be eligible for points.
107	For the Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Submission, if the FPDS-NG report is available, can it be used instead of the Attachment J.P-6?	No, in order to verify emerging technology experience, the project verification form, contract award document, and statement of work must be submitted in accordance with the requirements of L.5.2.3.1.1.
108	Must the J.P-6 be submitted for all Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Submission even when the Contract document and SOW is available for verification?	Yes, as noted in L.5.2.3.1.1, the signed Project Verification Form must be submitted in order to receive points for each submitted Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project.
109	Does the Government wish to receive the referenced SOW/PWS material in its entirety or just the pages with the tagged passages of the supporting documentation?	Offerors are to submit a copy of the SOW/PWS in its entirety.

110		Can other emerging technologies beyond those listed in L.5.2.3.1 be submitted for scoring?	No, as stated in L.5.2.3, each Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project must have included the performance of one of the Emerging Technologies listed in L.5.2.3.1 Emerging Technology Listing.
111		To receive points for each submitted Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project, the RFP states: "The Project Verification Form from the PSP signed by a Contracting Officer (CO) with cognizance over the submitted Project." Please confirm that for those projects being used as an Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project, offerors do not need to complete the information related to the Relevant Experience section (e.g., NAICS, OCONUS, etc.) if the project is not one from that group.	Correct. Information specific to Primary Relevant Experience Project Scoring is not required to be completed on the J.P-6 if the project is solely being utilized for Emerging Technology Relevant Experience.
112		Regarding L.5.2.2 Primary Relevant Experience Submission, can the offeror utilize subcontractors to meet the minimum of 3 Primary Relevant Experience Projects?	Yes. See L.5.1.3.2 for information on proposed subcontractors. As noted in L.5.1.3.2(3), Relevant Experience Projects may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor.
113		Does the offeror need to tag each item (NAICS Code, Cost Reimbursement, Dollar Size, Multi-Govt Customers (Funding Code), Multi-Award, & OCONUS) on the FPDS-NG for each project submission to receive credit for point credit for these items?	Tagging is not required for verification provided by FPDS but can be included to assist evaluators in validating the claimed scoring.
114		For L.5.2.2.5, how should a task order against a multiple-award contract be demonstrated when the task order was through a BPA under Multiple Award Schedule?	For L.5.2.2.5, to receive scoring for orders against a BPA on MAS, the Offeror should submit the FPDS records for the task order, BPA, and for the multiple-award contract that indicates "Multiple Award" within the "Multiple Or Single Award IDV" field.

115	In multiple places the RFP states “Note: Project value for completed federal projects is determined by the total obligated dollars. Project value for ongoing federal projects is determined based on the total estimated value (inclusive of all option periods).” J.P-3 FPDS Sample does not indicate how the Government will determine if a project is ongoing or completed. Would the Government please clarify how it will make this determination?	The Government will determine a project's status of ongoing or completed as of the proposal due date.
116	Is tagging areas of a primary project's PWS pdf file sufficient to justify other NAICS than what is listed in FPDS OR will the Government require additional project summary description/documentation as part of our submission?	Refer to Section L.5.2.2.1.1 Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Federal Government Contracts). If the FPDS-NG Report is not available or the FPDS-NG Report does not substantiate all claimed scoring elements, a signed Project Verification Form, Contract Award Document, and SOW must be provided.
117	If the offeror is submitting a Task Order that qualifies as a Relevant Experience Project will that Task Order also qualify as an award against a Multiple-Award Contract if the Task Order was issued under a single- award BPA that was procured under the GSA MAS? Assuming that the FPDS record shows a clear connection between the award under the MAS and the Task Order award.	Yes, the offeror should submit the FPDS records for the task order, BPA, and for the multiple-award contract that indicates “Multiple Award” within the “Multiple Or Single Award IDV” field.
118	Is scoring available for L.5.2.2.5 for a multiple award BOA?	Yes, Verification must be provided as required by L.5.2.2.5.
119	Can offerors provide narrative statements justifying why a certain phrase in the statement of work does indeed justify awarding points for an emerging technology, NAICS code, or cybersecurity?	Tags should be used within documents to identify the specific location of supporting information. Further elaboration/explanation should not be provided and will not be considered.
120	Please confirm our assumption that projects based on a single U. S. government federal grant are acceptable to use as relevant experience projects.	Yes, see Section L.5.2.1.

121		Regarding L.5.2.1, what documentation is required to show that performance was through the IDIQ itself and not under task orders?	As noted in L.5.2.1, an indefinite delivery, indefinite quantity contract may not be claimed as a project unless performance is evident through funding at the contract level. This could be demonstrated through obligations in the FPDS-NG Report or the contract award form.
122		Do offerors need to provide the full FPDS-NG report or only the fields required for verification?	When submitted for verification, the complete FPDS-NG Report should be provided. As noted in L.5.2.2.1.1, when multiple FPDS-NG Reports are available, the most recent report must be submitted as well as any previous reports necessary for verification of claimed scoring elements.
123		Can offerors provide either an FPDS-NG Report or a contract/task order cover page as acceptable documentation of a project's NAICS code?	See L.5.2.2.1.1. If the FPDS-NG Report is not available or the FPDS-NG Report does not substantiate all claimed scoring elements, the identified documents must be submitted for verification. That includes the Project Verification Form, contract award document, and Statement of Work.
124		For ongoing federal Projects that prove values using FPDS, kindly confirm the FPDS figure is the total column for the field labeled as "Base And Exercised Options Value:"	Project value for completed federal Projects is determined by the total obligated dollars. Project value for ongoing federal Projects is determined based on the total estimated value (inclusive of all option periods). Project value for non-federal contracts is determined based on the contract value listed on the Non-Government Award Form. As noted in J.P-3, for ongoing projects this would be demonstrated by the Total "Base and All Options Value (Total Contract Value)"
125		If a non-Federal award or contract does not identify the total value—or identifies only an initial value that actual performance has superseded—may Offerors submit other means of verification, such as invoices, to reflect actual value?	Yes, as noted in L.5.2.2.1.2 of Amendment 0004, total contract value must be clearly indicated on the award form or additional contract documentation must be submitted to validate contract value.
126		When entering a project performed as a subcontractor, is this considered commercial / non-federal experience even if the work was done for DoD?	Correct, for a project performed as a subcontractor, this would be State/International/Non US Fed Government/Commercial Project.

127		When claiming credit for cybersecurity services under L. 5.2.2.7 Relevant Experience Project Providing Cybersecurity Services, please confirm offerors only need to submit the contract SOW with tags on the relevant cybersecurity-related passages and that a signed Attachment J. P-6 is not required	No, all documents required by L. 5.2.2.1.1(2) or L.5.2.2.1.2 must be submitted for verification. As stated in L.5.2.2.7, the Offeror must provide documentation to verify the provided cybersecurity services in accordance with L.5.2.2.1.1(2) or L. 5.2.2.1.2. The Offeror must tag the specific written passages in the SOW or contract documentation that support the claim of the Project providing cybersecurity services.
128		Our firm has been a sub-contractor to other prime contracting companies on multiple federal contracts. Since we were a subcontractor not working directly with the Federal Agency, please confirm whether a Corporate Officer from our prime contractor can be the "Signature of Rater" on Attachment J.P-4 and Project Contact on parts II and III on J.P-6, and qualify as a federal project for our Polaris submission.	A corporate official from the prime contractor could be the Rater on those attachments, however, those contracts would not qualify as federal projects. IAW L.5.2.2.1.2, Verification of Primary Relevant Experience Submission (Non-Federal Contracts and Federal Government Subcontracts), this verification method should be used when relevant experience was performed as a subcontractor, EVEN if the subcontract was to a Prime Contractor performing a federal government contract.
Past Performance			
Q&R #	Question		Response
129		Please confirm that for a project that has been completed, and a final CPARS has not been submitted by the customer but other CPARS information exists, the Offeror must submit the CPARS, and not the J.P-4 Past performance rating form.	Correct. As noted in L.5.3.1, Past Performance (When CPARS information exists), if the Government has interim or final ratings in CPARS for the Relevant Experience Project(s) being utilized, the Offeror must provide a copy of this rating(s) report with its proposal. If a final CPARS rating is not available, the most current past performance information from CPARS will be used.

130		Our company has been awarded a multiple award contract against which a Federal Government agency has issued task orders. Rather than creating CPARS for each individual task order, the Government's contracting team has generated one, consolidated CPARS report for the entire multiple award contract. If we use a task order from this multiple-award contract as an example of past performance, can we submit the consolidated CPARS report to satisfy the requirements of L. 5.3.1? Or, do we have to provide a signed J.P-4 report to fulfill the requirements of L.5.3.2?	When a task order is submitted for the project, but the CPARS was completed at the contract level, the contract level CPARS should be submitted for L.5.3.
131		L.5.3 states "Only in the event CPARS information is not available will an Offeror be allowed to submit Attachment J. P-4, Past Performance Rating Form." Please confirm this applies only for Prime Federal Contracts where the Offeror was the prime for the project.	As CPARS will not be available for non-federal contracts (including projects performed as a subcontractor), Attachment J.P-4 should be utilized in accordance with L.5.3.2.
132		May we use a CPARS that came out after the solicitation was released but before the submission due date?	Yes, the most current past performance information at time of proposal should be included with the submission.
133		In Section L.5.3.2, if there's no final or internal CPARS, may the Offeror use the Past Performance Rating Form?	Offerors must use J.P-4, Past Performance Rating Form when CPARS information does not exist.
134		If the Offeror is unable to obtain a record of past performance on one of the five projects (either CPARS or Attachment J.P-4), and submits the required documentation stating this, will the Offeror still receive the maximum available Past Performance points (20,000)?	In this scenario, the Offeror would still be eligible to receive the maximum points (20,000). Reference M.5.2.2. If the Offeror submits less than five Primary Relevant Experience Projects, or a past performance assessment is unable to be obtained for a submitted Primary Relevant Experience Project, the per project point values will be adjusted to equal the maximum points possible for this factor. A total of 20,000 points are designated to this Past Performance evaluation factor, regardless of the number of past performance assessments received. The points available per assessment is dependent upon the number of assessments received.

135	Points are mentioned for 4 and 5 assessments, but not mentioned for 3 assessments. Is it safe to assume 3 assessments can get the maximum 20,000 points?	Yes, per Section M.5.2.2, Points Assigned to Past Performance Assessments, a total of 20,000 points are designated to this Past Performance evaluation factor, regardless of the number of past performance assessments received. If the Offeror submits less than five Primary Relevant Experience Projects, or a past performance assessment is unable to be obtained for a submitted Primary Relevant Experience Project, the per project point values will be adjusted to equal the maximum points possible for this factor.
136	How will the government be assessing past performance? Do we automatically receive points for just submitting 5 past performance projects?	Reference Section L.5.3. Past performance will be evaluated using Projects submitted under L.5.2.2 Primary Relevant Experience Submission. A past performance assessment must be submitted for each Relevant Experience Project submitted under L.5.2.2. No Past Performance assessments are required or requested for any projects submitted under L.5.2.3 Emerging Technology Relevant Experience.
137	M.5.2.2 states that an Offeror without a record of relevant past performance or for whom information on past performance is not available will receive 10,000 points. Please confirm.	Confirmed.
138	The Solicitation states "If the FPDS- NG report indicates that the principal place of performance was a CONUS location, then the Offeror must provide a copy of the contract SOW or documents from the contract that detail the OCONUS location(s) at which work was performed, contract award form and an authorized signature as described in L.5.2.2.1.1(2)."	In this situation, the CPARS may be provided as additional documentation to support the claim; however, all documents required by L.5.2.2.1.1(2) must also be provided.
139	Should the J.P-4 be utilized for a Federal subcontract?	Yes, please refer to L.5.3.2.

140		The score sheet shows the past performance to be 1 for 20,000? Is this accurate?	As noted in M.5.2.2, a total of 20,000 points are designated to this Past Performance evaluation factor, regardless of the number of past performance assessments received. The points available per assessment is dependent upon the number of assessments received.
141		Section M.5.2.1 Evaluation Ratings for Past Performance Submissions states projects will be evaluated as positive or negative based on their ratings "for the majority of rating elements on a Project." In CPARS reports, it's quite common for the government to select "N/A" for one or more rating elements. Please confirm "N/A" categories will not be factored in when tallying the scores for the "majority of rating elements".	Correct. Categories without a rating or noted as "N/A" will not be included in the assessment in determining whether a majority of the rating elements received a satisfactory or greater rating.
142		For Past Performance (M.5.2) if the bidder submits 5 Relevant Projects, do we have to submit a combination of 5 CPARS and Past Performance Rating Forms or could we score 20,000 points in that scenario if just 4 were received? Our assumption is that the government expects 5 CPARS and Past Performance Rating Forms in this scenario and if only 4 were submitted then only 16,000 points could be scored	As noted in M.5.2.2, a total of 20,000 points are designated to this Past Performance evaluation factor, regardless of the number of past performance assessments received. The points available per assessment is dependent upon the number of assessments received. Also reference L.5.3.2, if an offeror is unable to obtain a record of past performance (either CPARS or a completed Attachment J.P-4, Past Performance Rating Form) for any Primary Relevant Experience Project, the offeror must submit a document stating the inability to obtain a completed Attachment J.P-4 along with contact information for the appropriate Contracting Officer, Contracting Officer's Representative, Contracting Officer's Technical Representative or Corporate Officer/Official of the customer with cognizance over the Project
Systems, Certifications and Clearances			
Q&R #	Question		Response

143		Are there any certifications, systems, or clearances that are mandatory for Polaris?	As noted in L.5.4, the identified Systems, Certifications, and Clearances are not minimum or mandatory requirements; however, Offerors who demonstrate having these Systems, Certifications, and Clearances within their proposal will receive additional points.
144		Would the Government please confirm that for Joint Venture bidders, only one member of the JV need have the requisite paperwork to prove an approved accounting system?	Per L.5.1.3.1, Joint Venture, if applicable, L.5.4 Systems, Certifications, and Clearances - Offerors submitting as a joint venture must provide evidence of any claimed system, certification, or clearance in the name of the joint venture itself or in the name of a member of the joint venture.
145		Will GSA confirm that DCMA approval must not have been obtained within a certain time period? For example, approval from 10 years ago is still valid.	There is no defined timeframe for DCMA approval, but per L.5.4.1, Accounting System and Audit Information, by claiming scoring for this element, the Offeror certifies there have been no material changes to the accounting system since the last audit of its accounting system.
146		There appears to be a discrepancy between Section H.13, Accounting System, and L.5.4.1, Accounting System and Audit Information. H.13 does not include verification from a Third-Party Certified Public Accountant (CPA) as an option. Please explain.	There is no discrepancy. H.13, Accounting System, states the requirement for Offerors responding to cost-reimbursement type task orders. L.5.4.1 provides the criteria for obtaining points for evaluation at the Polaris master contract level.
147		Offerors submitting as a joint venture must provide evidence of any claimed system, certification, or clearance in the name of the joint venture itself or in the name of a member of the joint venture. In a JV bid, if all members of a JV hold certifications and FCLs at the same level, should the Offeror submit for just the one member, or submit for all members that hold the certifications?	Offerors submitting as a joint venture may provide supporting documentation for all members that hold a claimed system, certification or clearance.
148		Must any of the cited systems, certifications and clearances have been valid as of the initial proposal delivery date of May 13, 2022?	Systems, certifications and clearances must be held at the time of proposal submission.

149		Please confirm that in the case of any Small Business Joint Venture, the Facility Clearance Level (FCL) must be held by all JV members and that points will be awarded based on the highest FCL held by all members.	As noted in L.5.1.3.1, Offerors submitting as a joint venture must provide evidence of any claimed system, certification, or clearance in the name of the joint venture itself or in the name of a member of the joint venture. Points will be received for the highest level FCL held by the joint venture itself or a member of the joint venture.
150		Can a single Facility Clearance Letter document be used for multiple pools?	Yes, the same facility clearance letter document may be used for multiple pools.
151		For certifications, can the POC information be included in the same file as the certification?	Either a single file or separate files is acceptable.
Organizational Risk Assessment			
Q&R #		Question	Response
152		Please clarify whether a Joint Venture and its proposed subcontractor must have previously performed together on a contract or if it would be acceptable for a proposed subcontractor to have previously performed with one of the Joint Venture constituent companies, provided there is proof of a relationship.	See L.5.5.1, Organizational Risk Assessment, "Each proposed subcontractor has previously performed on a contract or order as a subcontractor to the offering prime contractor." For offers from a joint venture, the subcontractor must have previously subcontracted to the offering prime contractor, in this case the joint venture.
153		Does the Government require all firms in a joint venture to have previously worked together?	The Government does not require all members of a joint venture to have previously worked together. The evaluation factor, defined at L. 5.5.1, Organizational Risk Assessment, is not mandatory for submission but does provide additional scoring for demonstrating the Offeror has previously performed in the proposed business arrangement.
154		For the purposes of a business arrangement, must the prime contract that the proposed subcontractor performed on be a federal contract? Or can it be a commercial existing business arrangement in order qualify for the risk assessment points?	See L.5.5.1. This section includes no requirement for prior performance to be on a federal contract.

155		If an offeror is submitting a proposal as CTA with a subcontractor, do the offeror and the subcontractor have to have worked on a particular contract together in order for that contract to be submitted as a Relevant Experience Project, or as an Emerging Technology Relevant Experience?	No, the parties do not have to have worked together previously in order for the project to be submitted as a Primary Relevant Experience Project or an Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project; however, consistent with L.5.5.1, the offering business arrangement must have previously performed in the same business arrangement to receive scoring for the Organizational Risk Assessment factor.
156		Can the government please confirm that the offeror can claim points for Organizational Risk Assessment (L.5.5.1) for non-federal contract work as well as federal contract work?	Yes, to claim scoring for L.5.5.1, Organizational Risk Assessment, contracts or orders may be federal or non-federal.
157		Under Section L.5.5 Risk Assessment, does the Government require the contract/work previously performed together by the JV to also fall within the relevant NAICS codes of the solicitation?	The RFP does not contain a requirement for previously performed work to be within a relevant NAICS for consideration under L.5.5.1, Organizational Risk Assessment.
158		Will the Government provide scoring in L.5.5.1 for a business arrangement where the offering prime contractor is performing as a subcontractor to the proposed subcontractor?	No, as provided in L.5.5.1 - A prime contractor and its proposed subcontractors are considered to have previously performed in the same business arrangement if each proposed subcontractor has previously performed on a contract or order as a subcontractor to the offering prime contractor.
159		If the Offeror is submitting a response as an individual company [not proposing as part of a joint venture or not proposing any subcontractor(s)], will the Offeror receive 5,000 points for L. 5.5.1?	Yes, as noted in L.5.5.1, an individual company [not proposing as part of a joint venture or with proposed subcontractor(s)] will receive scoring for Organizational Risk Assessment. No additional verification is required for an individual company offering as itself.
160		If an offeror has an active subcontract with a teammate on an IDIQ contract responding to task order proposal requests, does that count as a previous business arrangement for L. 5.5.1?	No, as noted in L.5.5.1, an IDIQ contract or BPA without performance does not satisfy the requirement of this element for previous performance.
161		For the organizational risk element, what portions of the contract or order does the Government require?	The award form for the contract or order for which the work was performed must be submitted.

162		Can partial points be received for Organizational Risk Assessment for previous performance among some but not all of the proposed team?	No, the 5,000 points for Organizational Risk Assessment will be provided on an all-or- none basis in accordance with the requirements of L.5.5.1.
Teaming			
Q&R #		Question	Response
163		Is there a specific format that joint venture agreements must be presented to the government?	See L.5.1.3.1, Joint Ventures. The Offeror must submit a complete copy of the joint venture agreement that established the CTA relationship, and the agreement must meet the requirements of FAR 52.207-6, 13 CFR 125.8 and/or 13 CFR 125.9, as applicable.
164		If a subcontractor performed work for a prime contractor that may also compete for Polaris, will the project be removed if the prime also submits it as a project?	The prime contractor would be able to submit its prime contract as a Relevant Experience Project, AND the subcontractor would be able to submit its subcontract as its own Relevant Experience Project. The subcontract performance would be considered a commercial project.
165		Can the Offeror use their subcontractor's Approved Purchasing System that was approved by DCMA or CFA?	No, per L.5.1.3.2(3) Proposed Subcontractors, if applicable, Any systems, certifications, and clearances claimed within Section L.5.4 must be in the name of the Offeror. Systems, certifications, and clearances held by proposed subcontractors will not be considered for scoring and must not be submitted within the proposal.
166		Are additional documents required to be submitted for the conditions of L.5.1.3.1 (1) and (2)?	No additional documents are required beyond those already identified in L.5.1.3.1 (3) - (6).
167		Can the Government please clarify if a managing partner of a Joint Venture can only submit one single proposal per pool, or can they submit two proposals per pool: one as the prime and one as the managing partner of the Joint Venture?	As noted within L.3, Proposal Submission Instructions, "An Offeror (as identified in Block 15A of the SF33) may only submit a single proposal for this Pool. ... A small business concern may participate under multiple proposals (e.g., Offeror, proposed subcontractor, joint venture member), however, per L.5.2, Relevant Experience, no project, to include Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, may be used in more than one proposal under this Solicitation."

168		Can an Offeror include projects from its subcontractor when the project done by that subcontractor was done as part of a JV/CTA entity?	Reference L.5.1.3.3. An Offeror (to include members of a joint venture and proposed subcontractors) may use experience performed as a member of a joint venture, subject to the identified conditions.
169		Would GSA consider accepting a copy of the submitted mentor protégé agreement to the SBA, pending approval?	As stated in L.5.1.3.1(5), Joint Venture, if applicable, "If proposing as a Small Business Administration (SBA) Mentor-Protégé arrangement, the Offeror must submit evidence of SBA approval of its Mentor-Protégé Agreement."
170		Can an Offeror include a joint venture as a proposed subcontractor and use experience from the members of that joint venture?	Per L.5.1.3.2, Proposed Subcontractors, if applicable, Relevant Experience Projects may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor. Experience must be directly from the proposed subcontractor (not individual members or affiliates).
171		Can a SBA approved Joint Venture Mentor Protégé submit to GSA Polaris if the Mentor is an other than small business?	Yes, a mentor can be other than small business so long as the protégé is a small business for NAICS 541512. Reference 13 CFR 121.103(h)(1)(ii) - Two firms approved by SBA to be a mentor and protégé under § 125.9 of this chapter may joint venture as a small business for any Federal government prime contract or subcontract, provided the protégé qualifies as small for the size standard corresponding to the NAICS code assigned to the procurement, and the joint venture meets the requirements of § 124.513 (c) and (d), § 125.8(b) and (c), § 125.18(b)(2) and (3), § 126.616(c) and (d), or § 127.506(c) and (d) of this chapter, as appropriate.
172		Can a joint venture offer also include proposed subcontractors?	See L.5.1.3.1, Joint Venture, if applicable, which notes, "Additionally, if a joint venture submits a proposal utilizing small business subcontractors, the instructions in L.5.1.3.2, Proposed Subcontractors, if applicable, are to be followed in addition to L.5.1.3.1, Joint Venture, if applicable."

173		Can a vendor form subcontract arrangements after GSA Polaris GWAC award?	Yes, Polaris contractors have flexibility to establish subcontract relationships to fulfill task order requirements within the limitations identified at Section G.16.
174		Will the Government clarify if SBA Mentor-Protégé Approval Welcome Letters fulfill the requirement for evidence the SBA approved its Mentor-Protégé agreement?	Yes, the SBA Mentor-Protégé Approval Welcome Letter can satisfy the requirement of L.5.1.3.1 (6) for evidence of approval. The approved agreement must also be submitted.
175		Can contractors add subcontractors at the task order level, or do they need to be approved at the IDIQ level first?	Subcontractors are not approved at the contract level. Contractors may utilize subcontractors at the task order level. Reference Section G. 16.
176		Are all joint venture members required to provide an Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K, in addition to providing a copy of the annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov?	As stated within L.5.1.3.1 - The joint venture must submit both their annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K. Each member of the joint venture must also submit both their individual annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J. P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K.
177		Please confirm that Polaris Prime Offerors can submit their subcontractors' representations and certifications as part of their prime bid package.	Confirmed. Both the individual annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K must be submitted for each proposed subcontractor.
178		Do subcontractors in a CTA arrangement have to qualify as small as well?	See L.5.1.3.2, The Offeror and all proposed subcontractors must represent as small businesses for North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) 541512 within SAM.gov.

179		Please clearly define "similarly situated entities"	See FAR 52.219-14; Similarly situated entity, as used in this clause, means a first-tier subcontractor, including an independent contractor, that— (1) Has the same small business program status as that which qualified the prime contractor for the award (e.g., for a small business set-aside contract, any small business concern, without regard to its socioeconomic status); and (2) Is considered small for the size standard under the North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code the prime contractor assigned to the subcontract.
180		As per L.5.1.3.2 it requires to submit the subcontractor letter of commitment for each individual subcontractors, our question is – do we also need to submit the Prime – Sub teaming agreement document apart from subcontractor letter of commitment?	Per L.5.1.3.2, The Offeror must submit a Subcontractor Letter of Commitment for each proposed subcontractor. The RFP includes no additional requirement for submission of a subcontractor teaming agreement.

181		If we have an approved Mentor-Protege agreement but the Protege has grown to be a large business for NAICS 541512, will the JV be allowed to submit an offer on Polaris?	No, a mentor-protege joint venture with a protege who has outgrown its small business status may not compete in Polaris. Reference 13 CFR 121.103(h)(1)(ii) - Two firms approved by SBA to be a mentor and protégé under § 125.9 of this chapter may joint venture as a small business for any Federal government prime contract or subcontract, provided the protégé qualifies as small for the size standard corresponding to the NAICS code assigned to the procurement, and the joint venture meets the requirements of § 124.513 (c) and (d), § 125.8(b) and (c), § 125.18(b)(2) and (3), § 126.616(c) and (d), or § 127.506(c) and (d) of this chapter, as appropriate. For HUBZone, 13 CFR 126.616 (b)(2) reference A joint venture between a protégé firm and its SBA-approved mentor (see § 125.9 of this chapter) will be deemed small provided the protégé qualifies as small for the size standard corresponding to the NAICS code assigned to the HUBZone procurement or sale. For SDVOSB, reference 13 CFR 125.18 (b)(1)(ii) – A joint venture between a protégé firm that qualifies as an SDVO SBC and its SBA-approved mentor (see § 125.9) will be deemed small provided the protégé qualifies as small for the size standard corresponding to the NAICS code assigned to the SDVO procurement or sale.
182		If a company is part of a proposal based on a MRCL, can that same company also participate in a separate proposal as a member of a joint venture?	No, as stated within L.5.1.4, when an Offeror is sharing resources from other entities by way of a meaningful relationship within a corporate structure, only one proposal from that corporate structure may be submitted within this Pool.

183		Can scoring from L.5.2.2.6 (OCONUS) come from a JV member or from a subcontractor?	Yes. Scoring for L.5.2.2.6 is for Relevant Experience Projects submitted under L.5.2.2. For Joint Ventures, reference L.5.1.3.1 - Relevant Experience Projects may be from the joint venture or an individual member of the joint venture. For proposed subcontractors, reference L.5.1.3.2 - Relevant Experience Projects may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor.
184		During contract performance, can large business subcontractors participate on task orders?	Yes, consistent with the limitations of FAR 52.219-14, Limitations on Subcontracting, and Section G.16, large business subcontractors may be utilized in support of task order requirements.
185		Within M.4.2, must anything additional be submitted for proposed subcontractor verification?	Proposed subcontractor verification will be in accordance with the requirements of L.5.1.3.2.
186		For CTA teaming partners who do not want to share their completed GSA 527 or other financial information, is there an ability for the teammate to email this proprietary information directly to the government?	No, all proposal documentation must be submitted via the PSP in accordance with L.3.4.
187		For the Attachment J.P-7, please clarify whether the Government wishes a description of work done by each party, or whether it is requiring an exhaustive list of contracts performed by each party.	Per L.5.1.3.1(5), joint venture offerors must detail the work done individually by each partner to the joint venture as well as any work done by the joint venture itself previously. This can be provided by listing services previously performed. Consider referencing performance areas from Section C of the RFP. Specific contracts are not required to be identified within the Attachment J.P-7.
188		Section L.5.1.4 (MRCL) states that offerors can "take credit for Relevant Experience Project(s), system(s), certification(s), or Clearance(s)." Will the Government please confirm that Offeror's may also leverage an MRCL to satisfy CMMI appraisal requirements included in L.5.4.3?	Yes, CMMI (L.5.4.3) may be claimed via MRCL following the requirements of L.5.1.4.

189		Paragraph L.5.1.3, including all its subparagraphs, is related to Teaming Arrangements. If the offeror does not have any type of Teaming Arrangement, can the offeror write a paragraph simply stating Paragraph L.5.1.3 and all its subparagraphs are not applicable or does the offeror need to have separate documents dedicated specifically to each of the subparagraphs?	No additional documentation needs to be submitted for L.5.1.3.1 or L.5.1.3.2 if not proposing with a contractor teaming arrangement.
190		If we have a subcontractor that is a mentor protege JV, can we utilize their experience?	If the subcontractor mentor protege joint venture is a small business for NAICS 541512 within SAM.gov, then its relevant experience may be utilized consistent with the requirements of L.5.1.3.2 and L.5.2.
191		Will the Government allow offerors to modify the J.P-7 Joint Venture Work and Qualifications template to adjust column widths?	Yes, Offerors may make minor formatting changes to Section J and Section K templates used in proposal submission per L.3.
192		Will the Government allow offerors to modify the J.P-7 Joint Venture Work and Qualifications template to adjust font size to Arial 10?	Yes, Offerors may make minor formatting changes to Section J and Section K templates used in proposal submission per L.3.
193		Does the protégé have to provide only one primary relevant experience OR Emerging Technology Relevant experience project or both?	As noted within L.5.1.3.1, for offers from SBA Mentor-Protégé joint ventures, a minimum of one Primary Relevant Experience Project or Emerging Technology Relevant Experience Project must be from the Protégé or the offering Mentor-Protégé
194		In a Mentor-Protégé- Can a Mentor submit 3 Primary Relevant Experience Projects and 1 Emerging Technology Project?	Yes. As noted in L.5.1.3.1, no more than three Primary Relevant Experience Projects may be provided by the Mentor.
195		Will points be provided for L. 5.1.3.1(5), Attachment J.P-7?	No, this is not a scoring item on the Polaris Scoring Table, see M.6.
196		Can a single Letter of Commitment document be used for multiple pools if the same subcontractor is being used on those pools?	Yes, a single Letter of Commitment may be used for- multiple pools. The letter must be submitted in the PSP for each pool.

197	Do the subcontractors also need to complete GSA Form 527, Prof Employee Compensation Plan, Uncompensated Overtime Policy, etc.? Or, is this for Prime only.	Per L.5.1.3.2, responsibility information (including GSA Form 527, Professional Employee Compensation Plan, Uncompensated Overtime Policy, etc.) must be submitted for the Offeror. Responsibility information should not be submitted for any proposed subcontractors
198	Would the Government please confirm that the parent entity may prepare a single MRCL that identifies all elements in accordance with L.5.1.4, even if the parent organization is not the offeror? In other words, can a parent organization write a single MRCL that addresses meaningful relationships between the subsidiaries it controls, when it is one of those subsidiaries that is the offeror?	Yes, a single MRCL is allowed even if the parent organization is not the offeror.
199	We were a lead member of a Small Business Joint Venture where we performed work as a lead member of the JV. Can we utilize the relevant experience from that JV on a bid with another JV?	Reference L.5.1.3.3 for the ability to use experience performed as a member of a joint venture.
200	Can a subcontractor classify an eligible NAICS code with justification, even though the prime contract prime contract has a different code?	See L.5.2.2(a)(iii). It is acceptable for a subcontract NAICS to differ from the NAICS for the prime contract. Verification for the claimed NAICS must be provided in accordance with L.5.2.2.1.2.
201	Please confirm that an individual company submitting a proposal as itself including MRCLs qualifies as a “business arrangement” for which “No additional verification is required for an individual company offering as itself.”	For the purposes of L.5.5.1, no additional documentation is required for an individual company utilizing a MRCL.

202		If a small business is bidding as a prime, can that company also be a sub-contractor in another company's Small Business proposal?	Yes. As noted in L.3, An Offeror (as identified in Block 15A of the SF33) may only submit a single proposal for this Pool. An Offeror found submitting more than one proposal will have ALL of its proposals disqualified and removed from further award consideration. A small business concern may participate under multiple proposals (e.g., Offeror, proposed subcontractor, joint venture member), however, per L.5.2, Relevant Experience, no project, to include Primary Relevant Experience and Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, may be used in more than one proposal under this Solicitation.
203		Does the meaningful relationship commitment letter (MRCL) apply to a subcontractor of the prime offeror, in which subcontractor is a subsidiary of another company?	No, a meaningful relationship commitment letter may not be provided for a proposed subcontractor. As noted in L.5.1.4, the MRCL may be utilized by an offeror (to include a member of a joint venture).
204		Would the government please clarify whether an SBA Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture with two similarly situated members (i.e. – 2 members that are SDVOSB's) can provide the maximum number of relevant experience examples without restriction?	The restriction on the number of primary relevant experience projects that may be provided by the mentor is still applicable in this situation. See L.5.1.3.1.
205		Would the Government confirm that, If the Offeror chooses to prepare a single MRCL that identifies all required elements, the parent company's signature is the only signature required on the MRCL?	Yes, per L.5.1.4, in the event that a parent organization has complete and full control over all meaningful relationship entities, the parent entity may prepare a single MRCL that identifies all elements required.
206		If a Joint Venture is the proposing offeror does the attachment J.P-2 need to be used for every Relevant Experience claimed by the individual members in Joint Venture or just for experience claimed by Joint Venture as the Prime?	The Attachment J.P-2 is only to be utilized when claiming relevant experience performed as a member of a joint venture.
207		In the event that the members of a JV have worked together but have not worked together in the structure of a JV (i.e., initially worked as Prime/sub), how should this be notated in the J.P-7?	Information such as this may be noted within the "Work Done" field for the Joint Venture.

208	"The Government provides an example table requesting information on "Work Done - Identify experience and past performance through listing of services." QUESTION: Can the Government provide a clarification—for Attachment J.P-7, does each member of the JV provide a generalized listing of services, as to what the company offers as a whole on current/past performances OR do we insert listing of services pertaining to the contracts we reference in our submission?	Information submitted through J.P-7 is meant to provide work done and qualifications held generally and not be limited to the projects referenced and submitted for Polaris.
209	For the J.P-7, are we only to include work done and qualifications included for scoring elsewhere in the proposal?	No, the J.P-7 is not limited to work done and qualifications submitted for scoring.
210	Will past performances and/or certifications for members of the JV be accepted and evaluated for the team or does the lead of the JV need to have all qualifications	As noted in L.5.1.3.1, Past performance examples may be from the joint venture or an individual member of the joint venture. As for certifications, Offerors submitting as a joint venture must provide evidence of any claimed system, certification, or clearance in the name of the joint venture itself or in the name of a member of the joint venture.
211	Section L.5.1.3.1 states "Each member of the joint venture must also submit both their individual annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J.P-1 representations and Certifications from Section K". Does this mean that reps and certs for members are optional?	No. Representations and Certifications are not optional for joint venture members. As noted in L.5.1.3.1, each member of the joint venture must also submit both their individual annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K.
212	Are there any special considerations for DoD Mentor-Protege participants?	No. The conditions of L.5.1.3.1 apply to any joint venture offeror.
213	We are submitting a proposal as an SBA approved Mentor-Protege JV. Protege has a past performance as a subcontractor to a large business on a DOD contract. Will protege's experience satisfy the minimum requirement listed above and be used to claim points for primary relevant experience?	This can satisfy the requirement if the project meets requirements of L. 5.2.2 and/or L.5.2.3 as applicable. Appropriate verification documents must also be provided.

214		For the attachment J.P-2, if an offer is being submitted by a joint venture and a joint venture member is claiming experience performed as a member of a previous joint venture; how should Part I of J.P-2 be completed?	Within Part I of Attachment J.P-2: Offeror's Name - This field should identify the JV member that performed the work identified within Part IV. In the described situation, it would also be acceptable to note both the member and the name of the JV offering for Polaris. Joint Venture Name and UEI - These fields should identify the name and UEI for the Joint Venture awarded the contract or order identified within Part II of the Attachment J.P-2.
215		M.4.2 states: "Teaming arrangements without required documentation establishing the relationship will result in removal of claimed scoring elements and/or rejection of the proposal." For proposed subcontractors, what must be submitted for this requirement?	As noted in L.5.1.3.2, the Offeror must submit a Subcontractor Letter of Commitment for each proposed subcontractor.
216		We request the Government consider a situation in which a small business with an existing Mentor Protégé Joint Venture approved in October 2021, has a situation in which the large business has been acquired by another company. Will the Government please allow the acquiring company (who already had another Mentor-Protege Joint Venture in place and intends to bid on the Small Business Pool) to participate in multiple proposals as long as no projects are used more than in one proposal under the Solicitation Pool?	Please refer to SBA Regulations at 13 CFR 125.9(b)(3)(i), a mentor that has more than one protégé cannot submit competing offers in response to a solicitation for a specific procurement through separate joint ventures with different protégés.
217		Per L.5.1.3.1, please confirm if company X can form a JV A with an existing JV B and use a past performance that is in the name of JV B?	In this situation, yes, the experience and past performance of JV B may be utilized as they are a member of the offering joint venture. Per L. 5.1.3.1, Relevant Experience Projects may be from the joint venture or an individual member of the joint venture.

218		Per L.5.1.3.1, please confirm if company X can form a JV A with an existing JV B and use the facility clearance from one of the members of JV B?	In this situation, no, the facility clearance of a member of JV B would not be acceptable for scoring. Per L.5.1.3.1, any claimed system, certification, or clearance in the name of the joint venture itself or in the name of a member of the joint venture. In this instance, a clearance from Company X, JV A, or JV B would be acceptable for scoring.
219		For L.5.1.4, must each member of a JV submit a MRCL?	No, the requirements for an offer from a joint venture are specified in L.5.1.3.1, the use of a MRCL is specific to the situations detailed in L.5.1.4.
220		In a Prime/Subcontractor relationship, it appears that PSP requires the team member (subcontractor) to upload Business Factor information (e.g., Systems, Certs, Clearance). Will the government clarify which, if any, Business Factor information is required by the team member (subcontractor) in a Prime/Subcontractor relationship?	Reference L.5.1.3.2 for information regarding proposed subcontracts. Within the subcontractor's Business Factors section, the representations and certifications for the proposed subcontractor must be attached.
221		For JVs, should each member of the JV upload the print out that confirms their electronic SAM.gov reps and certs or is the Government strictly relying on the electronic information within SAM.gov for each Team Member entity that is not the offeror in addition to the completed and uploaded J.P-1 Representations and Certifications information for their evaluation?	As stated in L.5.1.3.1, the joint venture must submit both their annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K. Each member of the joint venture must also submit both their individual annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov as well as Attachment J. P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K. The representations and certifications from SAM.gov, as well as J.P-1, must be attached for both the JV and each member.

222	Can the government clarify this statement further? "Experience must be directly from the proposed subcontractor (not individual members or affiliates)." Should we understand this to mean that any Relevant Experience Project from a JV subcontractor must be from the named JV and not any individual member of the JV?	Yes, per L.5.1.3.2, Relevant Experience Projects may be from the Offeror or any proposed subcontractor. If a joint venture is included as a proposed subcontractor, experience may be submitted for the joint venture but not individual members.
223	Would the government please clarify whether a WOSB, SB, SDVOSB, or HUBZone company can partner with a Large business as a Subcontractor?	See L.5.1.3.2, the Offeror and all proposed subcontractors must represent as small businesses for North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) 541512 within SAM.gov.
Representations and Certifications		
Q&R #	Question	Response
224	Can Attachment J.P-1 from Section K and SAM reps and certs be submitted as one file or would the Govt prefer two separate files?	Please submit these documents as separate files.
225	For representations and certifications completed within SAM.gov, which report should be provided?	For the copy of the annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov required by L.5.1.2, the FAR Report from sam.gov should be submitted.
226	Would the Government please clarify whether Offerors must include in their proposals a copy of the annual representations and certifications completed electronically in SAM?	As stated within L.5.1.2, the Offeror must submit Attachment J.P-1 Representations and Certifications from Section K, in addition to providing a copy of the annual representations and certifications completed electronically within SAM.gov.
227	Do the reps and certs have to be signed by each individual teaming member?	Signatures are not required on submitted reps and certs.
Responsibility		
Q&R #	Question	Response
228	May audited prepared financial statements be used in lieu of completing Section IV: Income Statement?	As noted within L.5.6.3, Financial Resources, Blocks 24–28: Submit statements for the last two full fiscal years and interim statement for the current year. You must attach the financial and interim statements rather than write the figures on the GSA Form 527 – Page 2.

229		Do the financial statements need to be broken out separately by fiscal period or do the years need to be consolidated into one financial statement?	As detailed within L.5.6.3, Financial Resources, separate statements should be submitted for each of the last two full fiscal years and interim statement for the current year.
230		If proposed subcontractors are included in a proposal, is a GSA Form 527 required for each proposed subcontractor?	Financial responsibility documents are not required for proposed subcontractors.
231		If proposing as a joint venture, is a 527 required for the joint venture in addition to the 527 for each member of the joint venture?	Financial responsibility documents are not required for the joint venture entity. As stated within L.5.1.3.1(3) (sixth bullet), Joint Venture, if applicable, financial responsibility documents required by L.5.6 must be submitted for each member of the joint venture.
232		Does GSA have a template or a required format for the uncompensated overtime policy?	A template will not be provided. Please refer to the requirements of L.5.6.2 and FAR 52.237-10.
233		As part of the Professional Compensation Plan, do we need to include the national and regional compensation surveys and studies for each Labor Category or include a sample of the types of studies and surveys conducted to achieve rates?	In reference to FAR 52.222-46, supporting information is not required to be attached but may be referenced within the provided Professional Employee Compensation Plan.
234		Does the Government have a format to be used for the Professional Employee Compensation Plan?	No prescribed format or template is provided for the Professional Employee Compensation Plan. Please refer to the requirements of L.5.6.1 and FAR 52.222-46.
235		Must a Professional Employee Compensation Plan be provided as part of Polaris GWAC proposals?	A Professional Employee Compensation Plan must be provided within the proposal as stated within L.5.6.1 and L.5.6.1.1.
236		Will the PSP allow teammates to submit documents so that their financial information can only be viewed by the Government?	The PSP does allow teammates to individually access the portal to upload required documents; however, the offering entity has complete ability to view all documents prior to proposal submission.

237		For L.5.6.1 and L.5.6.1.1, will the Government please clarify if salary ranges are required for each labor category?	In accordance with L.5.6.1.1 (FAR 52.222-46), offerors must submit a total compensation plan setting forth salaries and fringe benefits proposed for the professional employees who will work under the contract. The compensation levels proposed should reflect a clear understanding of work to be performed and should indicate the capability of the proposed compensation structure to obtain and keep suitably qualified personnel to meet mission objectives. The salary rates or ranges must take into account differences in skills, the complexity of various disciplines, and professional job difficulty. Offerors should identify anticipated salary rates or ranges for each labor category listed within Attachment J-2, Labor Category Descriptions.
238		"Reference: L.5.6.3 Financial Resources Submission" To show additional sources of financial resources, we assume that for instance the bidder should show sources of credit in their "SECTION VIII - REMARKS" of GSA Form 527 and could attach items such as line(s) of credit showing their other financial resources."	Lines of credit should be identified within Section V. As noted in L.5.6.3 for Section V, if your company has a prepared list of bank and trade references, you may attach it to the GSA Form 527 instead of completing this section.
239		Can a single GSA Form 527 document be used for multiple pools?	Yes, the same GSA Form 527 may be submitted for multiple pools.
240		Would the Government please confirm if the intent is for offerors to provide within their Professional Employee Compensation Plans the actual LCATs relevant to Polaris as provided in RFP Attachment J-2? If yes, would the Government please confirm that a single salary range per Labor Category that covers the salary across all knowledge/skill levels with the range starting at Junior and ending with Subject Matter Expert be acceptable?	Salary rates or ranges do not need to be specifically identified for each skill level, only the overall labor category. For example, a salary range may be identified that encompasses all skill levels for a labor category (rather than separate rates or ranges for Junior, Journeyman, Senior, and SME categories individually).

241	Is responsibility documentation (financial information, compensation plan, overtime policy) required from proposed subcontractors?	No, financial information, compensation plan and overtime policy are not required from proposed subcontractors. See L. 5.1.3.2.
242	L.5.1.3.1 states for Uncompensated Overtime Policy “may be either from the Joint Venture or from each member of the joint venture”. Can GSA confirm that as long as one member submits, this requirement is satisfied?	No, as stated in L.5.1.3.1, the Uncompensated Overtime Policy may be either from the Joint Venture or from each member of the joint venture. If not provided from the joint venture, the Uncompensated Overtime Policy must be submitted by all members of the joint venture.
243	Who is required to complete J-P. 5 GSA Form 527 in a JV relationship?	As noted in L.5.1.3.1, Financial responsibility documents required by L.5.6 must be submitted for each member of the joint venture.
244	Should financial statements be attached to the submission as separate documents or appended directly to the GSA Form 527 as a single document?	Either method is acceptable.
245	The RFP states for bidders to provide financial statements (for JV members each member must submit) in lieu of populating the GSA Form 527 for financial information. Please confirm that this only applies to page 2 of the form and all other pages of this document should be populated to the best of our ability.	Correct. This applies to the GSA 527, Section III - Financial Statements and Section IV - Income Statement.
246	Please confirm that the salary information provided for the Professional Employee Compensation Plan will be evaluated for reasonableness as opposed to calculating a total cost.	As noted in 52.222-46, the Government will evaluate the plan to assure that it reflects a sound management approach and understanding of the contract requirements. No assessment of pricing or total cost will be part of this evaluation.
247	For our Professional Employee Compensation Plan, which geographical location should be used?	For the Professional Employee Compensation Plan, the RFP provides no specific location. Offerors may specify a locality as appropriate.
Polaris Submission Portal (PSP)		
Q&R #	Question	Response

248		Where can I find the website and register to allow my company to submit its proposal?	As provided in L.3.4, the Polaris Proposal Submission portal is accessible at https://polaris.app.cloud.gov . Once you click on "I Accept." Select "Need a new account? Register Now" to register to PSP.
249		Can Offerors add additional employees or team members to have access to the PSP for proposal preparation?	Yes, there are no restrictions on the number of users that may be added for a proposal. Please refer to How to Manage Users (https://gettingstarted.apexlogic.com/support/solutions/articles/35000160891-how-to-manage-users) for more information.
250		Please provide instructions on how to tag in PSP.	Reference the Help link within the PSP for tagging instructions: https://industriysupport.apexlogic.com/support/solutions/articles/35000192996-how-tags-work-in-symphony-for-polaris
251		Step 3: Highlight and Tag your Evidence for Project Data in "How Tags work in Symphony for Polaris" lists six tags. May Offerors add other tags as necessary?	Yes, Offerors may add additional tags. Reference the Help link within the PSP for tagging instructions.
252		Can GSA provide instructions on where they would like the SF-33 form to be uploaded with the PSP?	To submit SF-33 in PSP, (1) Click the submission "Continue" button, (2) Click on the "Submission" button on the left, (3) Select SF-33 from the select box and (4) Upload SF-33 document.
253		If there is a JV member of one pool and is also bidding as prime on a second pool, can they have two separate login ids into PSP?	These are 2 separate submissions and would be created under different UEIs. Proposal documents would need to be added separately to the different submissions.
254		Is tagging required for the signed SF33 and SF30 forms by the offeror's proposal submission?	No, tagging is not required for the signed SF33 and SF30.
255		Does the Government have specific requirements related to the file naming convention for each file uploaded to the PSP (e.g., OfferorName_L.5.1_SF33)?	No, the Government does not have specific naming conventions for files uploaded to PSP.
256		Are there any file size limitations Offerors should be aware of for uploading documents to the Polaris Submission Portal?	Each file must not exceed 20MB.
257		Are offerors able to submit multiple PDF files in response to a single RFP requirement?	Yes, Offerors may submit multiple PDF files.

258		Please confirm it is acceptable to use Adobe's PDF Portfolio file to combine multiple electronically signed PDF documents into a single file so it can be submitted through the portal.	PDF files will be viewed in a web browser. It is not recommended to use portfolio files because neither MS Edge or Google Chrome browsers support viewing portfolio PDF.
259		Can the Government please confirm that "tags" for all supporting documentation to be submitted via 'Tools' and selecting the add 'Comment' feature within Adobe?	The comment feature is one method of tagging that works. Sticky Notes are another.
260		What are "performance factors" referenced in the Polaris Submission Portal?	For the purposes of the PSP, Performance Factors are data elements that are solicitation specific. After you add a project to a submission you will be able to add this information in the list of projects by selecting the "begin" button in the Functional Factors column. The next page will show you the Performance Factors that you can claim.
261		Please confirm that the PSP requirement to "tag" documentation only applies to required and scored elements for Relevant Experience Projects L. 5.2 elements? For other required or scored elements under L.5 that are obvious, it does not appear that tagging would be necessary or required.	Per L.4, Offerors are encouraged to utilize comments ("tags") in Relevant Experience supporting documentation indicating the specific reference for verification purposes. Failure to tag supporting documentation may result in an inability of the government to validate claimed scoring.
262		There doesn't appear to be a section in the PSP to upload the SF 30s. Please clarify where and how offerors should submit this documentation.	The SF 30 is uploaded in the submission documents button on the left menu inside of each submission.
263		Is there any tagging required for the J.P-1 and SAM reps and certs submission?	No tagging is required for J.P-1 or SAM Representations and Certifications

264	If an offeror is proposing as a Contractor Teaming Arrangement (CTA), can the Government please clarify how to add this team member in the Polaris Submission Portal? In the "New Team Member" section - the PSP only provides the option to add the following types of partnerships: 1) Subcontractor; 2) Joint Venture Member; 3) Joint Venture Subcontractor; 4) Mentor in an SBA Mentor Protégé Program; and 5) Protégé in an SBA Mentor Protégé Program.	When adding a team member, the type of Contractor Teaming Arrangement as provided by L. 5.1.3.1 or L.5.1.3.2 must be selected from the dropdown.
265	Based on the PSP, it is unclear where the JV agreement referenced in L.5.1.3.1 should be uploaded.	Upload the JV agreement referenced in L.5.1.3.1 inside the team members documents upload.
266	L.5.1.3.2 4. Where does the offeror submit the "Subcontractor Letter of Commitment (LOC)" within the PSP for each subcontractor on the offeror's team?	The Subcontractor Letter of Commitment (LOC) is uploaded in the Team Member's Supporting Documentation area.
267	Will the Government please confirm that the offeror is allowed to use virtual sticky notes in addition to the highlights inside of submitted SOWs/PWSs to provide further elaboration/explanation on vague task descriptions, and that these will be read and evaluated?	Tags should be used within documents to identify the specific location of supporting information. Further elaboration/explanation should not be provided and will not be considered.
268	In the PSP, when entering Project information in the Tab "Complete Your Project Details" will the optional entries "Locations for project performance" and "Were subcontractors/teaming partners involved in this project" impact the number of points awarded for the primary relevant projects?	No, these fields are not applicable to M.6, Polaris Scoring Table and will not be evaluated.

269		The Solicitation states "Project Verification Form (Either from the PSP or Attachment J.P-6) signed by a Contracting Officer (CO) with cognizance over the submitted Project." Our plan is to submit the Government provided J.P-6 signed form via the PSP as a PDF. Since the Government mentioned "either," Is there another option offered by the PSP?	In the PSP, you can generate the form in the project page by clicking the "Generate as PDF" button in the My Company/Projects/Project name. Both the Project Verification Form from the PSP or Attachment J.P-6 are acceptable.
270		When entering project information in the PSP, should the claimed Funding Agency ID be selected for the customer agency?	Yes, the customer agency selected should be based on the claimed Funding Agency ID.
271		Within the PSP, where can offerors indicate a project's relevance to Emerging Technology?	After you add a project to a submission, you will be able to add this information in the list of projects by selecting the "begin" button in the Functional factors column.
272		Could GSA provide a guide for "tagging" in PSP?	Reference the Help link within the PSP for tagging instructions: https://industriysupport.apexlogic.com/support/solutions/articles/35000192996-how-tags-work-in-symphony-for-polaris
273		Please confirm if the submission document in the PSP titled "Confidentiality Disclosure Statement" is reserved for the optional cover page mentioned in the Q&A.	Correct, the optional cover page may be submitted through the Confidentiality Disclosure Statement in the dropdown.
274		Where should offerors upload the required Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture Agreement and SBA Approval document with their proposal package?	Teaming documents should be included inside the team members documents upload.
275		In the Relevant Experience section there are questions regarding "How many locations?" and "Were teaming partners involved?" Can you please confirm if bidders are required to complete these fields?	There are several optional fields in the Project Details screen since this project data may be used for other solicitations that require this information. They are optional for entry and do not impact the Polaris submission.
276		Will the Government please add an upload area for the J.P-7?	The J.P-7 upload is in the submission documents button on the left menu inside of each submission.

277		What should I do if the funding ID is not available on the drop down menu?	If you do not see the funding agency in the select field, please submit a copy of the FPDS report to client.support@apexlogic.com . If you do not see the funding agency in the select field and do not have an FPDS report identifying the requested federal customer agency, please send an email request to Polaris@gsa.gov identifying the requested federal customer agency.
278		For Primary Relevant Experience, Emerging Technology Relevant Experience, and Cybersecurity files, where is this information provided?	Since this data is solicitation specific, after you add the project to a submission you will be able to add the "location in the file" information or tag by selecting the begin button in the Functional Factors column.
279		Please confirm that if two companies have formed an SBA Mentor Protégé Joint Venture, those two companies shall register as separate Team Members under the JV's UEI ("My Company") in the portal.	Yes, add them to the Team Members of the Joint Venture.
280		When adding Primary Relevant Experience projects to our proposal in PSP on the "Performance Factors" page, the PSP requires us to select the file reference and state the location in the file (page number, section, paragraph, etc.). It is unclear how offerors are supposed to complete the "location" field since there's many different scoring elements. Unlike the Emerging Technology and Cybersecurity fields that relate to a particular page in our contract SOWs, there's no one location that we can point the evaluators to for the entire Primary Relevant Experience project. The reference file for this element is some combination of the FPDS report, contract award document, Attachment J.P-6, etc. What "location in the file" is the government looking for?	Use a single tag to identify where support for the claimed Primary Relevant Experience (NAICS) is found in all your documents. Using the same tag in multiple locations and files makes it easier to find the proof of your claims.

281	The tags legend includes "TCV" for "Total Contract Value" However, the term, "Total Contract Value" is not consistent with the RFP. In Section L. 5.2.2.2, the Government states that, "Project value for completed federal Projects is determined by the total obligated dollars. Project value for ongoing federal Projects is determined based on the total estimated value (inclusive of all option periods). Project value for non-federal contracts is determined based on the contract value listed on the Non-Government Award Form.) In this context, would the Government please define "Total Contract Value?" And, if a contract's total obligated dollars or total estimated value conflicts with the "Total Contract Value," which project value should an Offeror tag?	The TCV tag should be utilized for the claimed project value.
282	Is portal access restricted to Prime Offerors only?	Prime offerors may provide teammates access to the proposal within PSP.
283	For the Organization Risk Assessment, will the government confirm that if an individual company is offering as itself, they do not need to upload any supporting documents on the PSP and can simply check the "I Certify the claim of Organizational Risk Assessment." checkbox?	Yes, as noted in L.5.5.1, an individual company [not proposing as part of a joint venture or with proposed subcontractor(s)] will receive scoring for Organizational Risk Assessment. No additional verification is required for an individual company offering as itself.
284	Does the reference to submitting PSP tickets at least 36 hours in advance refer to 36 actual hours or 36 business hours?	The reference in L.3.5 is 36 actual hours.
285	Where does the offeror's Polaris Team subcontractor's J.P-1 from section K and SAM reps and certs files get uploaded in PSP?	Please upload the SAM Reps and Certs to the Team Member's Business Factors, and the J.P-1 goes inside the team members documents upload.